

The opener describes

With the second bid opener tells how strong the hand is and how it is shaped: partner needs two bids to know.

1 Decide or describe?

Non-forcing response

Opener **decides**: pass, invite or bid game.

One-over-one response

Opener describes **strength and shape**.

Two-over-one response

Opener describes **shape only**: game is already assured.

2 Minimum and strong hands

Minimum · 12-15

Describe the hand without passing the safety level.

Strong · 16-20

Go past the safety level to show the extra strength.

Safety level: the last contract beyond which, with no fit and only 18-19 points between you, a reasonable result is no longer sure.

3 Minimum hand after a one-over-one

Balanced

Safety level = **1NT**

1♥ – 1♠ – ?

♠ J7 ♥ KQ943 ♦ AQ65 ♣ J7

Unbalanced, safety level 2♥: diamonds fit below it → **2♦**.

Unbalanced

Safety level = **2 of the opening suit**

1♣ – 1♠ – ?

♠ AK7 ♥ QJ43 ♦ 42 ♣ KJ86

Balanced, safety level 1NT: hearts would go past it → **1NT**.

4 Strong hand: go past the safety level

After a one-over-one response, with a strong hand opener always describes it by going past the safety level.

1♣ – 1♦ – ?

♠ AKJ7 ♥ Q43 ♦ 4 ♣ AKJ86

Spades with a jump → **2♠**: at least 16 points, four spades and long clubs.

1♥ – 1♠ – ?

♠ A7 ♥ AQ943 ♦ 4 ♣ AKJ86

Within the safety level it would be 2♣; the jump → **3♣** shows the strength.

1♦ – 1♠ – ?

♠ A987 ♥ AK3 ♦ KQ874 ♣ 6

16 points and four spades: raise to the 3 level → **3♠**.

BALANCED 18-20

Too much for 1NT, too little to open 2NT: jump to **2NT** (1♥ – 1♠ – 2NT).

5 After a two-over-one

The response is forcing to game: opener describes, whether minimum or strong.

WEST 1♦ – EAST 2♣ – WEST ?

♠ 93 ♥ AK73 ♦ KQJ5 ♣ 983

Nothing extra, but opener describes → **2♥**. East, no longer worried about that suit, bids 3NT.

6 Then responder

After a one-over-one, once opener has bid twice:

1NT, old suit at minimum level	not forcing
2NT, old suit with a jump	invitational
new suit	forcing

A new suit is the only way to make opener bid again: it acts as a prod and needs no length.